



Lecture 1



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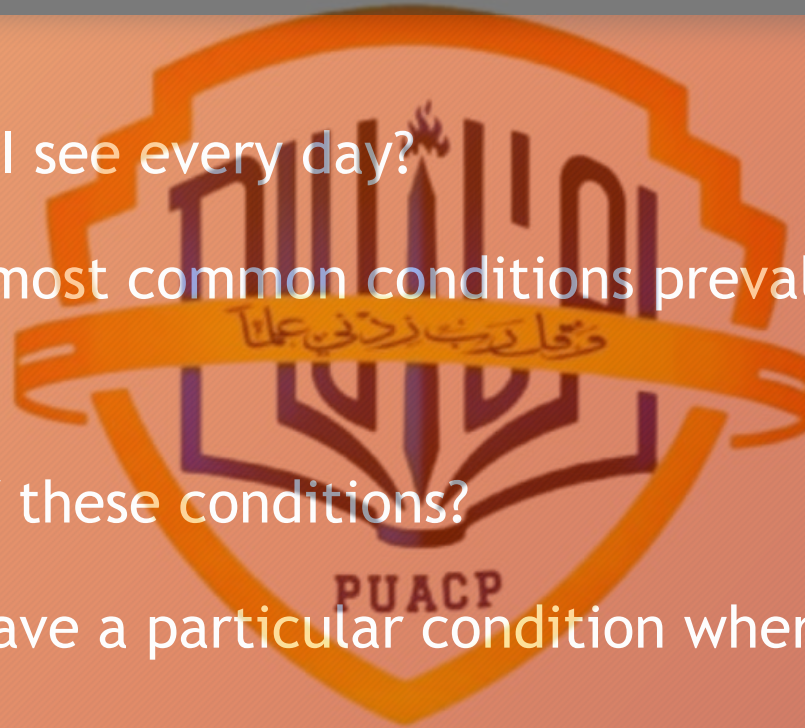
Introduction to Research



As a “Health Worker”

Following questions may come to your mind

- How many patients do I see every day?
- What are some of the most common conditions prevalent among my patients?
- What are the causes of these conditions?
- Why do some people have a particular condition whereas others do not?
- What are the health needs of the community?
- What are the benefits of this Programme to the community?



- How do I demonstrate the effectiveness of my service?
- Why do some people use the service while others do not?
- What do people think about the service?
- How satisfied are patients with the service?
- How effective is the service?
- How can the service be improved?

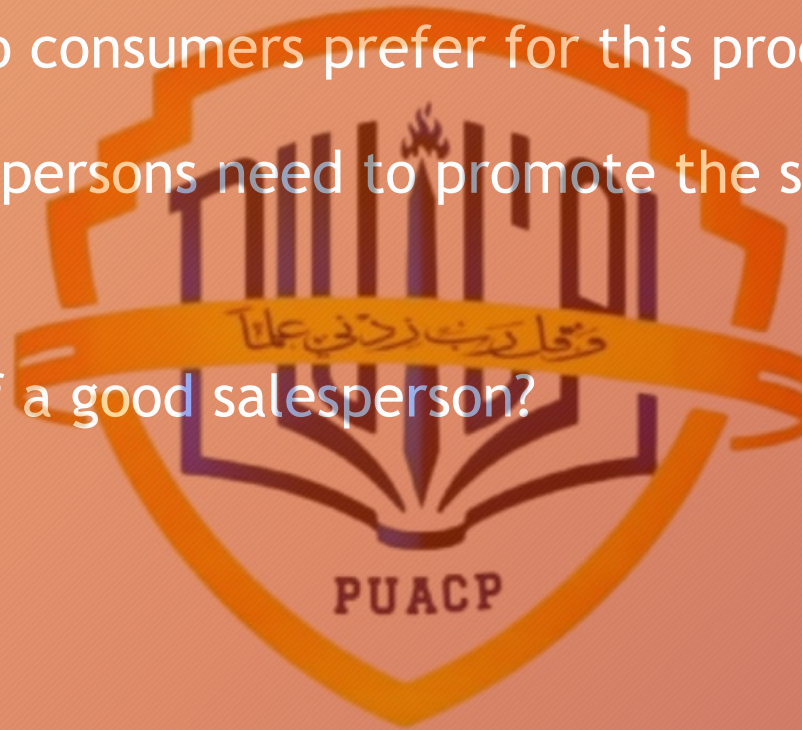


In business studies; Questions may come to your mind

- What is the best strategy to promote the sale of a particular product?
- What is the effect of a particular advertising campaign on the sale of this product?
- How satisfied are the consumers with this product?
- How many salespersons do I need?



- How much are consumers prepared to spend on this product?
- What do consumers like or dislike about this product?
- What type of packaging do consumers prefer for this product?
- What training do the salespersons need to promote the sale of this product?
- What are the attributes of a good salesperson?



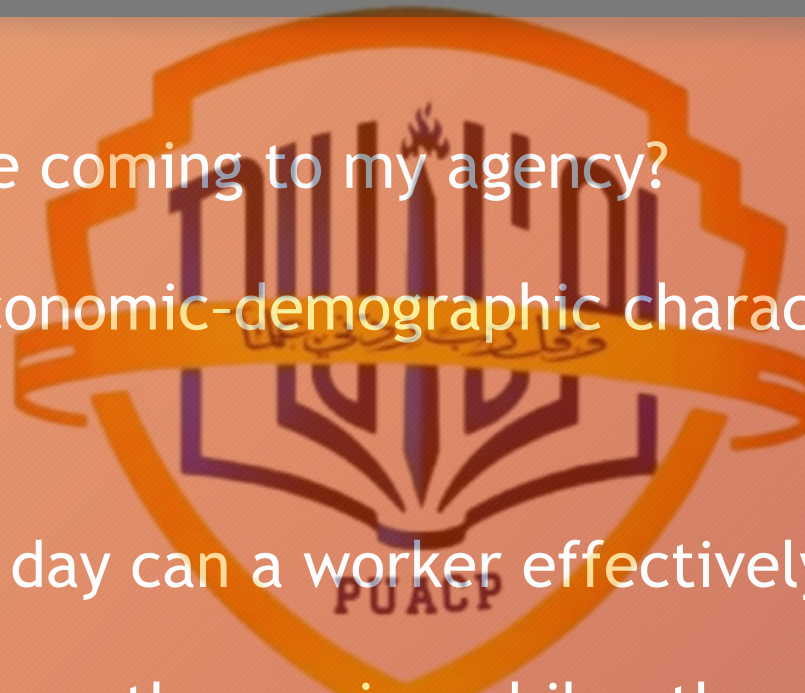
As a psychologist; Questions may come to your mind

- What are my clients' most common presenting problems?
- What are their most common underlying problems?
- What is the socioeconomic background of my clients?
- Why am I successful in certain cases and not in others?
- What resources are available in the community to help a client with a particular need?
- What intervention strategies are appropriate for this problem?
- How satisfied are my clients with my services?

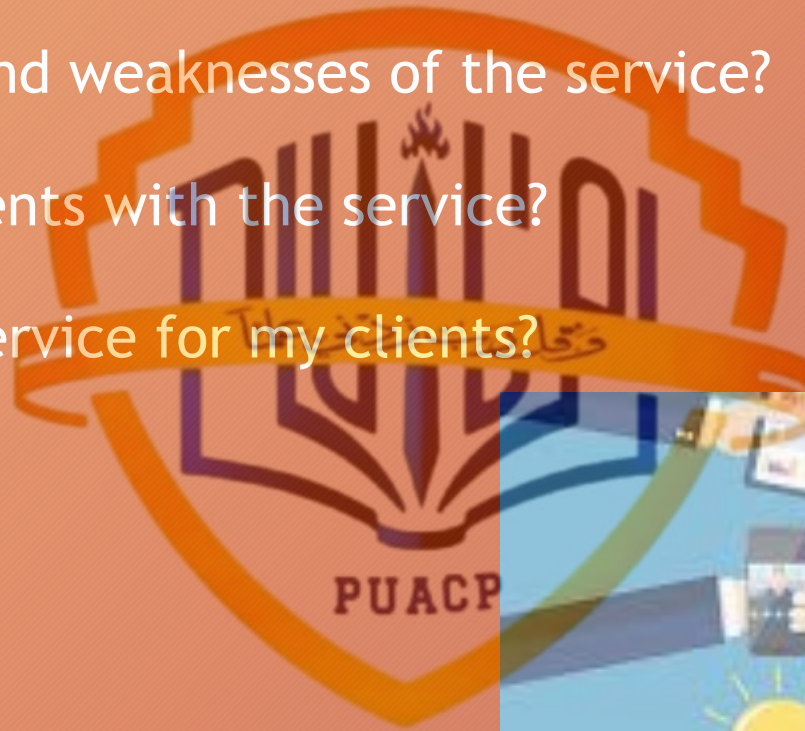


as a manager of an agency; Questions may come to your mind

- How many people are coming to my agency?
- What are the socioeconomic-demographic characteristics of my clients?
- How many cases in a day can a worker effectively handle?
- Why do some people use the service while others do not?

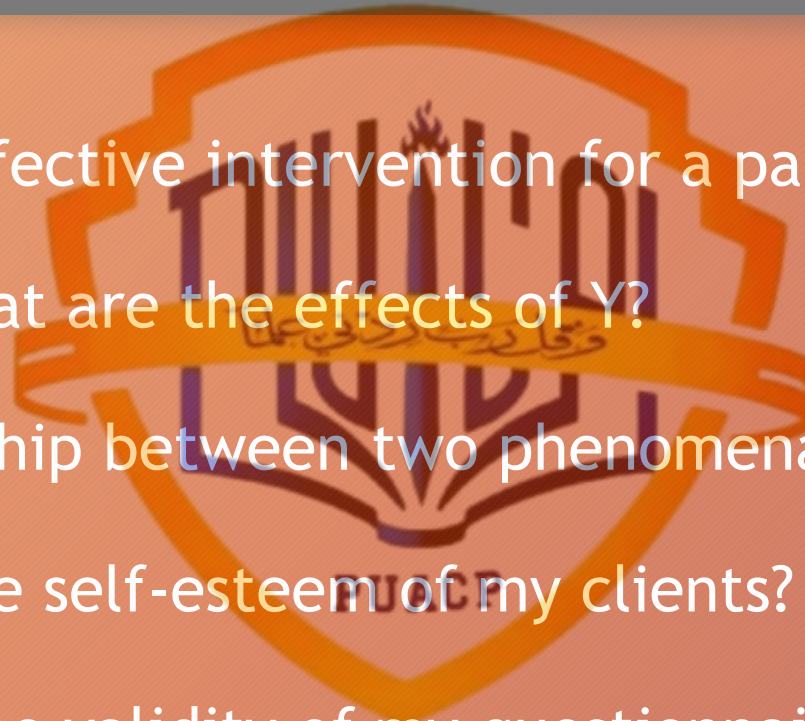


- How effective is the service?
- What are the most common needs of clients who come to this agency?
- What are the strengths and weaknesses of the service?
- How satisfied are the clients with the service?
- How can I improve this service for my clients?



as a professional; Questions may come to your mind

- Which is the most effective intervention for a particular problem?
- What causes X or what are the effects of Y?
- What is the relationship between two phenomena?
- How do I measure the self-esteem of my clients?
- How do I ascertain the validity of my questionnaire?



- What is the pattern of programme adoption in the community?
- Which is the best way of finding out community attitudes towards an issue?
- Which is the best way to find out the effectiveness of a particular treatment?
- How can I select an unbiased sample?
- What is the best way to find out about the level of marriage satisfaction among my clients?



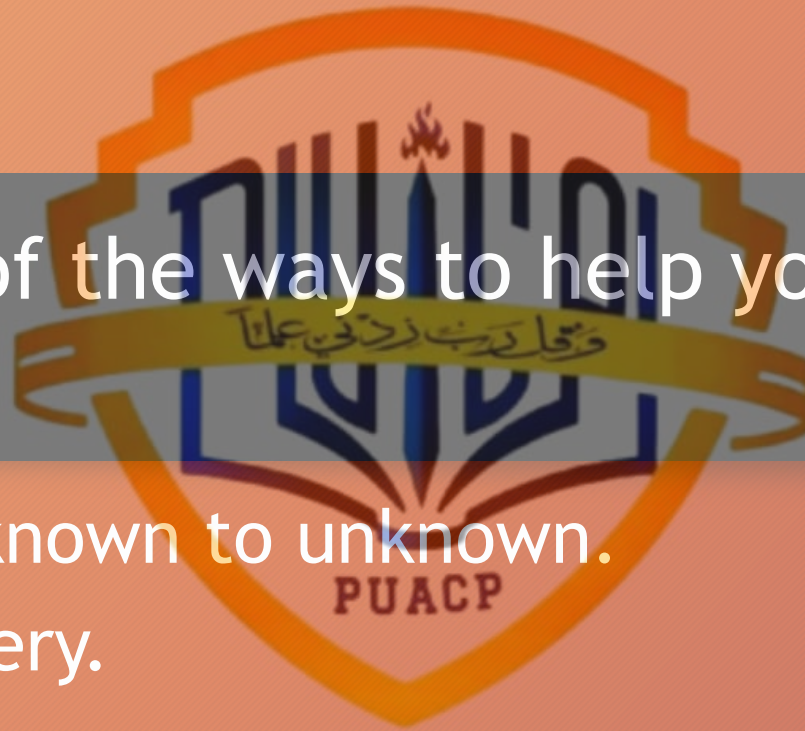
questions that a consumer may ask are:

- How effective is the service that I am receiving?
- Am I getting value for money?
- How well trained are the service providers?



Research is one of the ways to help you answer such questions

A movement from known to unknown.
A journey of discovery.





Research is composed of two words

Re & search

Which denote “Searching again and again”

Definitions of Research

- Research is an art of scientific investigation. (C. R. Kothari)
- Research is a systematized effort to gain new knowledge (Redman & Mory)
- Research is a systematic investigation to find answers to a problem (Burns)
- Research is a process in which you engage in small set of logical steps (J. W. Creswell)



According to Oxford Advanced learner's Dictionary



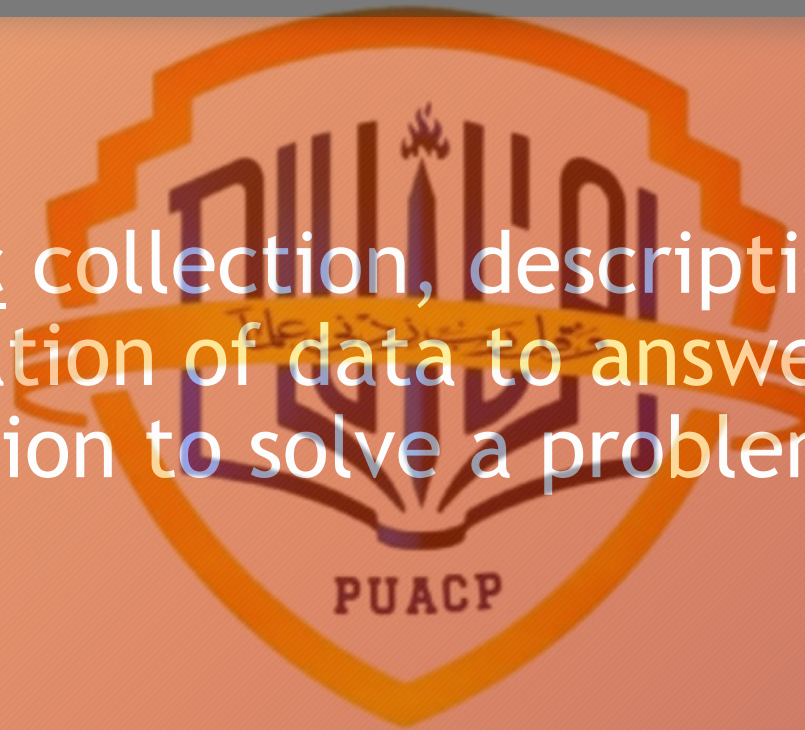
“A careful investigation or inquiry especially through search for new facts in any branch of knowledge.”

Meanings of Research

Research is a scientific approach of answering a research question, solving a problem or generating new knowledge through a systematic and orderly collection, organization, and analysis of information with an ultimate goal of making the research useful in decision-making.

In other words

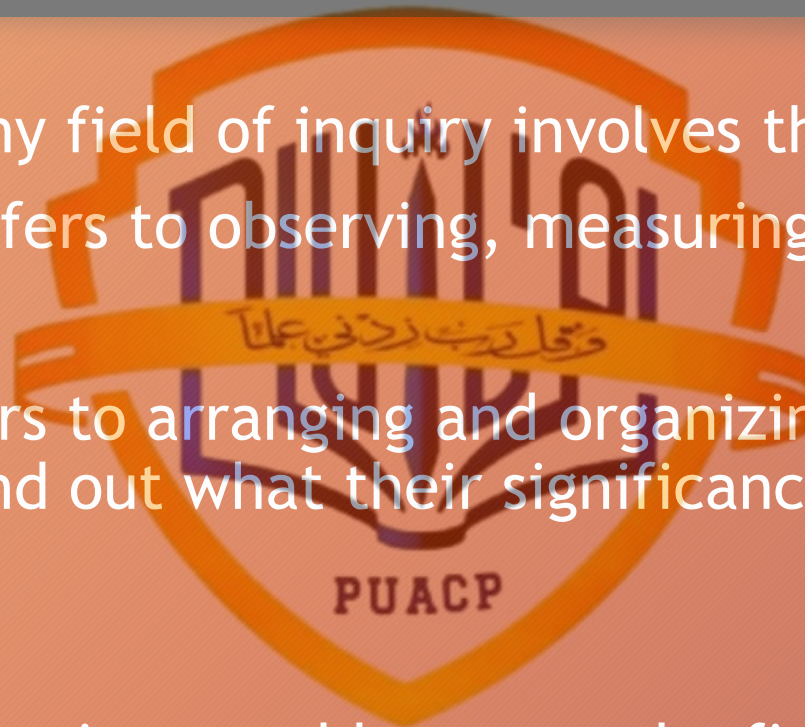
The systematic collection, description, analysis and interpretation of data to answer a certain question to solve a problem.



Operations in Systematic research

Systematic research in any field of inquiry involves three basic operations

- i. **Data collection:** It refers to observing, measuring, and recording information.
- ii. **Data analysis:** It refers to arranging and organizing the collected data so that we may be able to find out what their significance is and generalize about them.
- iii. **Report writing:** It is an inseparable part and a final outcome of a research study. Its purpose is to convey information contained in it to the readers or audience.



Good VS Bad Research

- There is only one type of research: good research.
- Bad research does not deserve the name of research.
- Badly done research is not only a waste of time, money and effort.
- It can be considered unethical if it exposes research subjects to the inherent risks of experimentation with no reward



The use of complex instrumentation is not a necessary requirement for good research.

Key attributes of good research are proper planning, accuracy in data collection and unbiased interpretation.

Thanks

